TopSpot40

Music, Memories & Moments

ACTIVITY DIRECTOR GUIDE



A PRACTICAL RESOURCE FOR SENIOR LIVING

Music Memories and Connection for Residents

TopSpot40 helps activity professionals turn familiar music into welcoming, flexible programs that invite residents to listen, remember, move, talk, and choose together. The narrated stories are the heart of the experience: they give each song context and open the door to memories and conversation.

Group Programs

Use guided playlists, narrated stories, TV themes, collections, and resident requests for shared activities.

Room Visits

Take TopSpot40 to a resident room for bedside listening, a personal visit, family time, or a quieter experience.

Inclusive Participation

Residents may sing, hum, tap, dance, share a memory, request a favorite, or simply enjoy listening.

What TopSpot40 Provides

- Nostalgia Programs organized by decade and genre, including TV Themes.
- Collections built around musical styles, celebrations, heritage, moods, and special interests.
- Artist Spotlights with artist stories and eligible tracks.
- Music Docuseries featuring narrated stories about people, events, innovations, and movements in music history.
- Guided Play, Auto Play, a Resident Request Queue, and Name That Song activities.

BEFORE THE FIRST SESSION

Simple Setup for a Smooth Program

For Gary's Demonstration

- Gary brings the computer and uses his own signed-in Spotify account.
- TopSpot40 provides the program organization, narration, stories, and guided experience.
- Spotify opens separately to play the recorded music.
- Connect the computer to the room speakers or Eversound system and test the volume before residents arrive.

For Ongoing Facility Use

- Install the Spotify desktop app on the computer used for TopSpot40.
- Sign in to the facility's appropriate Spotify account before the activity.
- Confirm a reliable internet connection and keep the computer connected to power.
- Test one TopSpot40 selection, Spotify playback, speakers, and headphones before every session.

Use a Television or Use Audio Only

Connect to a TV

Display TopSpot40 on the television so residents can follow the program and view available lyrics on the larger screen.

Audio Only

A television is optional. Use room speakers, headphones, or Eversound in a group space or resident room when a screen is not needed.

Five Minute Room Check

Internet ✓ Spotify signed in ✓ Sound tested ✓ Seating arranged ✓ Catalog and requests ready ✓

FLEXIBLE FOR ANY CALENDAR

A Repeatable Session Formula

1 Welcome

Name the theme and invite residents to get comfortable.

2 Invite

Ask one easy memory question with no right or wrong answer.

3 Listen

Use Guided Play or Auto Play for the selected songs and narration.

4 Connect

Pause for stories, movement, recognition, or a resident request.

5 Close

Invite a favorite, vote for next time, or end with a familiar selection.

Choose the Right Length

15 Minutes

Two or three familiar selections, one question, and a closing favorite. Ideal for a short visit or memory-care group.

30 Minutes

A focused theme with four to six selections, brief narration, discussion, and one resident request.

45 to 60 Minutes

A complete program with stories, movement, requests, conversation, and a meaningful closing selection.

CHOOSE BY INTEREST AND ENERGY

Program Ideas Residents Can Recognize

Nostalgia and TV Themes

- Decade Time Machine
- Name That TV Show
- Finish or recognize the theme
- Western Night with classic television
- Music from residents teen and young-adult years

Collections and Artists

- Artist of the Week
- Dance Floor Favorites
- Love Songs and Friendship
- Cultural and heritage celebrations
- Resident DJ and favorite-artist requests

Stories and Social

- Behind the Music Docuseries
- Then and Now conversation
- Room-to-room music visits
- New Resident Welcome session
- Family Life Story playlist
- Request Hour using the queue

TV Themes Are a Natural Conversation Starter

Ask which programs the family watched, who controlled the television, which characters residents remember, and whether a theme brings back a particular room, person, or time of day.

MAJOR MOMENTS ON THE ACTIVITY CALENDAR

Birthdays Holidays and Celebrations

Monthly Birthday Celebration

- Choose music from the years when birthday residents were teenagers or young adults.
- Create a resident spotlight with favorite artists, songs, television programs, hometown, and family memories.
- Build a Birthday Time Capsule using music, TV themes, and cultural moments from the resident's birthday year.
- Use the Request Queue so each birthday resident chooses a song; include the resident's first name with the request.
- Invite family members to submit a favorite song or memory in advance.

Holiday and Heritage Programs

- New Year and fresh beginnings; Valentines Day love songs; spring and Easter memories.
- Memorial Day, Independence Day, Labor Day, Veterans Day, Thanksgiving, and Christmas or winter celebrations.
- Halloween novelty songs, television themes, and mystery programs.
- Black History Month, Hispanic Heritage Month, and other observances meaningful to the residents and community.
- Ask residents which traditions, foods, dances, services, or family gatherings they remember.

THREE LANGUAGE RESIDENT GROUPS

Inclusive Facilitation and Memory Care

Every TopSpot40 voice file is available in English, Spanish, and Brazilian Portuguese. Choose the narration language that best serves each resident or group; the recorded songs remain in their original language.

Conversation Prompts

What does this song remind you of?
¿Qué recuerdos le trae esta canción?

Did you dance to this song?
¿Bailaba usted con esta canción?

Who was your favorite singer?
¿Quién era su cantante favorito?

What television shows did your family watch?
¿Qué programas de televisión veía su familia?

Would you like to hear this one again?
¿Le gustaría escuchar esta canción otra vez?

Memory Care Approach

- Use familiar choruses, artists, and TV themes.
- Ask simple questions without testing residents.
- Welcome humming, smiling, tapping, gestures, or quiet listening.
- Do not correct a resident's memory or require a correct answer.
- Keep sessions shorter, repeat favorites, and watch for fatigue.
- Invite safe movement from seated or standing positions.

Connection matters more than remembering the correct answer.

TURN RESIDENT INTERESTS INTO A CALENDAR

A Sample Week and Planning Map

Sample Weekly Schedule

Monday	**Memory Lane**	1960s Pop and memories
Tuesday	**Television Tuesday**	TV Themes and Name That Show
Wednesday	**Artist Spotlight**	Featured artist story and songs
Thursday	**Request Hour**	Requests in Guided or Auto Play
Friday	**Dance and Social**	Upbeat music and movement
Weekend	**Family Connection**	Favorites with visiting family

Resident Interest Map

Decade

1950s 1960s 1970s 1980s Other

Music

Country Pop Rock RNB Latin Jazz Folk

Favorite artists

_____

Favorite TV shows

_____

Birthday month

_____

Language

English Español Both

Participation

Group One-to-one Family

RESIDENT CHOICE DRIVES THE EXPERIENCE

Requests and Name That Song

Resident Request Queue

- Residents can ask for a numbered catalog selection and the activity director adds it to the queue.
- Attach a resident's first name to a request so the group knows whose favorite is playing.
- Reorder requests, choose Play Next, remove a selection, or clear the queue.
- Use the queue in Guided Play or Auto Play. When it is empty, TopSpot40 returns to the selected program.
- Use Request Hour for birthdays, resident-led socials, family visits, or end-of-session favorites.

Name That Song

- The track plays before the title, artist, introduction, and details are revealed.
- Residents may guess the song, artist, television show, decade, or musical category.
- Use hints when helpful, then reveal the answer and enjoy the TopSpot40 narration.
- Keep scoring optional. Recognition, laughter, and shared memories are the goal.
- Combine Name That Song with the Request Queue, TV Themes, decades, collections, or a birthday time capsule.

Custom Radio for Continuous Listening

Select the residents' preferred genres or collections, start Custom Radio, and let TopSpot40 continue building and playing musical sets. Staff do not need to choose each song or remain at the controls. This works well in a lounge, during a social hour or quiet afternoon, or in a resident's room. Follow the facility's normal resident-supervision and sound-level policies.

A resident does not need to know the answer to participate and enjoy the moment.

PHOTOCOPY FOR INTERVIEWS / FOTOCOPIE PARA ENTREVISTAS

Resident Music Preference Form

Resident name / Nombre _____ **Preferred name / Nombre preferido** _____

Room / Habitación _____ **Completed with / Completado con** _____

Preferred narration language / Idioma de narración preferido

☐ English / Inglés ☐ Spanish / Español ☐ Brazilian Portuguese / Portugués de Brasil

Favorite decades / Décadas favoritas

☐ 1950s ☐ 1960s ☐ 1970s ☐ 1980s ☐ 1990s ☐ 2000s ☐ 2010s ☐ 2020s

Favorite music and programs / Música y programas favoritos

☐ Country ☐ Pop ☐ Rock ☐ RNB Soul ☐ Latin Global ☐ Blues Jazz ☐ Folk Acoustic ☐ TV Themes

Favorite artists / Artistas favoritos _____

Favorite TV programs / Programas de TV favoritos _____

Program code / Código _____ **Song number / Canción** _____

Preferred way to participate / Forma preferida de participar

☐ Group / Grupo ☐ Room visit / Visita al cuarto ☐ Family / Familia ☐ Independent / Independiente

PHOTOCOPY AND CUT APART / FOTOCOPIE Y RECORTE

Resident Program and Song Request Slips

TopSpot40 Request 1

Resident / Residente _____ **Room / Habitación** _____

Program code / Código _____ **Song number / Canción** _____

Song or artist / Canción o artista _____

Play as / Reproducir como ☐ Guided / Guiado ☐ Auto / Automático ☐ Name That Song / Adivina ☐ Custom Radio / Radio

Narration / Narración ☐ English / Inglés ☐ Spanish / Español ☐ PT-BR

TopSpot40 Request 2

Resident / Residente _____ **Room / Habitación** _____

Program code / Código _____ **Song number / Canción** _____

Song or artist / Canción o artista _____

Play as / Reproducir como ☐ Guided / Guiado ☐ Auto / Automático ☐ Name That Song / Adivina ☐ Custom Radio / Radio

Narration / Narración ☐ English / Inglés ☐ Spanish / Español ☐ PT-BR

Every Song Holds a Story

A song can carry us across decades—to a childhood home, a school dance, a family celebration, or an evening spent with someone we loved. Music reconnects us with people, places, and moments that remain part of our lives.

TopSpot40 brings those connections to life through carefully chosen programs, narrated introductions, artist stories, and musical history. Listen to a complete program, explore a favorite artist or collection, or discover something entirely new.

Whether you listen alone, with family and friends, or as part of a group, we hope TopSpot40 helps you remember something meaningful, share a story, and enjoy the music that connects us.

Music, memories, and moments—shared one song at a time.

Thank You for Listening

TopSpot40 — Music, Memories & Moments